

Apple Inc.
AAPL NASDAQ

Buy **\$322.25** ▼ **1.12%** **12M Price Target** **\$360.00** **52-Week Range** **\$201.50 – \$334.99** **Market Cap** **\$4.73T**

AAPL: The Anti-AI Trade Meets Tariff Reality Check

WHAT HAPPENED

- AAPL is down 1.1% and has now bled ~3.5% over five sessions from \$333 highs — the trigger appears to be Trump's expected tariff announcement today, hitting the same day the EU fined Google \$1B. Translation: Big Tech is getting squeezed from both sides of the Atlantic simultaneously, and Apple has the most physical supply chain exposure of any megacap.
- Interesting narrative shift — Yahoo Finance is now calling AAPL the "anti-AI trade." That's code for: investors nervous about AI capex bubbles (Meta, Google, MSFT spending \$80B+ each) are hiding in Apple because it's NOT spending like a drunk sailor on data centers.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's the tension: Apple is being rewarded for NOT being an AI-capex monster, but punished for being a China-exposed hardware company right as Trump reloads on tariffs. Those two forces are colliding today. The options flow tells you the smart money is hedged both ways — heavy put buying at \$315 and \$317.50 (people paying for downside protection) but also aggressive \$322.50 call buying (people betting the tariff news is already priced in). What this probably means: expect a volatile 48 hours, but the low volume today (8M shares vs. 40M+ normal) suggests most institutions are waiting for the actual tariff details before moving. If tariffs land softer than feared, this snaps back to \$330+ fast.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

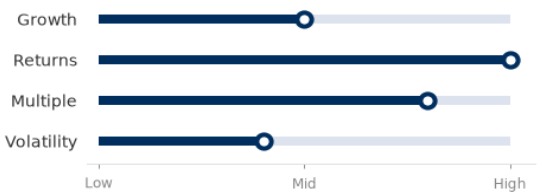
The immediate catalyst is Trump's tariff announcement expected today — Apple assembles ~85% of iPhones in China and India, so any new electronics tariff hits gross margins directly (each 10% tariff = roughly \$8-10B in annualized cost pressure). Watch for whether iPhones get a carve-out like they did in 2019 — Tim Cook has been personally lobbying the White House and Apple committed \$500B in US investment earlier this year specifically to earn goodwill. Second front: the EU's Digital Markets Act enforcement is intensifying (Google just got hit for \$1B), and Apple's App Store is the next target — a similar fine and forced structural changes to App Store economics would hit Services revenue, which is Apple's highest-margin business.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$322.25
12M Price Target	\$360.00
Upside / (Downside)	+11.7%
Market Cap	\$4.73T
FY2026E Revenue	\$425M
FY2027E Revenue	\$455M
FY2026E EPS	\$7.25
FY2027E EPS	\$7.95
Fwd P/E	44.4x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



AAPL — Apple Inc. | July 23, 2026

PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$340.00	\$325.00	\$305.00
6 Months	\$365.00	\$335.00	\$290.00
1 Year	\$400.00	\$360.00	\$275.00
2 Years	\$460.00	\$390.00	\$260.00
5 Years	\$600.00	\$480.00	\$300.00
10 Years	\$850.00	\$625.00	\$350.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Energy (+1.91%) and Industrials (+1.81%) — this is the "Trump trade" rotation, betting on tariffs boosting domestic manufacturing and energy independence policy. Money is flowing to companies that benefit from protectionism.

COOLING OFF: Technology (-0.53%) — Big Tech is caught in the crossfire of both EU regulation and US tariff policy. The mega-caps that led the rally are now the funding source for the rotation.

ROTATION WATCH: Classic risk rotation out of expensive Tech into cyclical and value. This is a "sell what's worked" moment, not a broad market panic — indexes are holding up because the rotation is orderly.

RELATED PLAY: If you like Apple's cash-return story but want less China risk, look at MSFT or GOOGL (though Google has its own EU headache today). If tariffs get harsh, US-manufacturing plays like semiconductor equipment names benefit from reshoring tailwinds.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- XOM (Exxon Mobil): Energy sector leadership tied directly to expected Trump energy policy and Middle East tension premium.
- CAT (Caterpillar): Industrials benefiting from infrastructure spending narrative and tariff-driven reshoring bets.

AAPL CONTEXT: Apple is lagging the broader market today but outperforming the tech sector on a 5-day basis — that "anti-AI safe haven" narrative is real. It's not leading, but it's holding up better than pure-play AI names, which tells you institutions view it as defensive tech. That's a shift from 2023-2024 when Apple was viewed as the growth laggard.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 5-8% of portfolio (core holding)

Entry Points: \$310-315 on tariff-driven pullbacks

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: China tariff escalation above 25% on electronics, or iPhone unit sales decline >8% YoY

Hedging: Buy protective puts around earnings, or pair with a short position in a China-exposed semiconductor name